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REALTY

LUXURY

FOR HOMEOWNERS WHO MIGHT SELL

Thinking About *Next Year?*



Three low-pressure things to do this fall if a move is even a maybe, written for the foothills, plus how to sell and buy at the same time without losing sleep.

CINDY LITZINGER

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This is not intended as a solicitation if your property is currently listed with another broker or if you are currently working with a licensed real estate professional.

Thinking about next year?

You might sell next year. You might not. Either way, the homeowners who come out ahead in spring are the ones who did three small things in the fall. None of these commit you to anything, and all of them are free.

1 Know your number (the website guess isn't it)

Online estimates are built from tax records. They don't know about your kitchen, your view of the lake, your oaks, your pool, or what the home down the road actually closed at last month. On acreage they are usually off by a lot. A real number comes from closed sales near you in the last 90 days, adjusted by a person who has walked homes like yours. Knowing it changes every other decision: what to fix, when to list, and what you can afford on the other side.

2 Spend on what buyers here actually pay for

Every neighborhood has a short list of things buyers pay extra for and a long list they don't care about. The most expensive mistake I see is spending on the second list.

USUALLY WORTH IT IN OUR MARKET

- Outdoor living that photographs: covered patio, clean landscaping, a view framed instead of hidden
- A kitchen and primary bath that feel finished, not necessarily new
- Fresh neutral paint, updated lighting, refinished floors
- Pre-inspection with the small items fixed
- On acreage: current well and septic reports, defensible-space clearing, and a tidy barn or shop. Buyers from out of the area ask about all three.

USUALLY NOT WORTH IT

- A full remodel started six months before listing
- Pools, additions, or anything you won't finish before spring
- Personal-taste upgrades the buyer will redo anyway
- Expensive fixes to things a pre-inspection wouldn't even flag

I'll walk your home and give you the short list for your street. Please don't spend a dollar before you know.

3 Pick your window

Spring sells fastest and for the most here, but a spring launch is built in the fall: updates in November and December, photography in January, a private preview before the public sees it, launch in late February or March.

Want to be listed by March? Start the plan in October. By May? Start in December. Late summer? Start in March.

Selling and buying at the same time

Most of the people I work with aren't just selling. They're moving: closer to the grandkids, up to acreage, down to one story, or out of state entirely. That's two transactions, and the order matters.

APPROACH	HOW IT WORKS	BEST WHEN
Sell first, then buy	Close your sale, then shop with cash in hand and a known number	You can be flexible on timing or have somewhere to land
Buy first, then sell	Secure the next home, then list yours with a clear deadline	Your equity and income can carry both briefly
Sale contingency	Your offer on the next home depends on your sale closing	You need the equity to buy and want one clean move
Rent-back after closing	Sell, then stay for a set period while you close on the next one	You want the sale price locked without a double move

I handle both sides, so you're never negotiating one without the other, and the timelines are built to fit together.

Even a small chance you sell next year? Do these three things this fall. The rest can wait, and so can the decision.

A little about me: I'm a luxury listing specialist with eXp Luxury, and I ran businesses before real estate, which is why my plan is always in writing. My team and I work Placer, Sacramento, and El Dorado Counties, from Granite Bay and El Dorado Hills to Loomis, Auburn, Folsom, and East Sacramento, and homes that didn't sell the first time are a big part of what we do. You will get a straight answer from me, in writing, before you sign anything.

NEXT STEP

Start with a real number, *not a guess.*



SCAN FOR YOUR
HOME VALUE FROM
CLOSED SALES

Scan for your current home value from closed sales in your neighborhood. Whether you're selling, buying, or both, the first conversation is free, confidential, and with me, not an assistant.

Call or text 805-478-1412

Email cindy@luxandland.com ·
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Book a time calendly.com/realcindylitz

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